



Board of Works February 11, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=6P98KffRHCY
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Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety Meeting Summary

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting of the Muncie Board of Public Works and Safety was called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:19](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Ted Baker, Lola Mauer, and Linda Gregory.
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Not explicitly named in opening roll call, but led the proceedings.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance [00:00:21](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes of the February 4th meeting were approved as presented by voice vote [00:00:53](#).

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- [00:01:16](#) Register of Claims

- **Presenter:** City Controller Craig Wright.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Controller Wright presented the register of claims, noting it was a "credit card week" making it lengthier than normal. Key items highlighted included Indiana Michigan Power expenses for traffic signals/street lights, Tyler Technologies software fees split with the county (New World fees), and a restricted Neighborhood Venture Home (NVH) fund payment to 3D Company for the Columbus Avenue reconstruction totaling \$272,940.91, alongside standard utilities and health care claims. Total claims presented amounted to \$1,307,095 00:02:26.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:02:38.
- **00:02:41 Street Closure Application: Ball State University Spring Commencement**
 - **Presenter:** Lieutenant Anthony Hurst, Ball State Police Department Special Events Training Coordinator 00:02:51.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Lieutenant Hurst requested a road closure for McKinley Avenue between Riverside Avenue and University Avenue on May 2nd from approximately 8:00 a.m. to 12:31 p.m. to manage roadway security and safety for the spring commencement event.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:03:31.
- **00:03:38 Street Closure Application: Woodlands Community Anniversary Event**
 - **Presenter:** Connie Keiger, Marketing and Admissions for The Woodlands 00:03:46.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request to close the street from the east side to the west side of the building on May 14th from 2:00/3:00 p.m., with the event running from 5:00 to 8:00 p.m., featuring live music, vendors, and food trucks to ensure attendee safety. The board reminded the presenter that the city and police department do not provide physical barricade/closure services; the organization is responsible.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:04:44.
- **00:04:52 Veridus Police Station Phase One Contract**
 - **Presenter:** The Mayor 00:05:00 and Chief Sloan 00:08:52.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor discussed ongoing infrastructure challenges at the current police building, specifically severe basement flooding affecting the property (records) room, HVAC issues, and downtown parking constraints caused heavily by police vehicles. To avoid overburdening city engineers (who face heavy road projects like Tillotson) and to stop uncoordinated internal searches, the administration proposed a 6-month personal services contract with Veridus (costing approximately \$40,000 funded out of budget) to lead a structured search evaluating current, city-owned, and external properties. Chief Sloan added that aging infrastructure, water leakage down walls during heavy rain, and recruitment needs make this an essential first step.

- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None during this agenda item. (See Open Public Comment for later public testimony on this item).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:10:31](#).
- **00:10:37 L&W Billboard Contract for 2026**
 - **Presenter:** The Mayor [00:10:43](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual contract for billboards located on I-69 (one for northbound traffic before the Daleville exit, and one heading south before the McGalliard/Muncie exit). While traditionally utilized for Iron Man for 3–4 months, the city plans to keep the billboards active for a full year to promote additional city activities and hit targets for “Fire Up.”
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:11:53](#).
- **00:11:57 Right-of-Way Use Application: Art Installation**
 - **Presenter:** Carl Shafer, Gordy Framing [00:12:08](#).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Shafer, working with local sculptor Aaron Nicholson and Minnetrista, requested a temporary (maximum 24 months) right-of-way permit to place a 10-foot-tall public sculpture celebrating the 50th anniversary of the movie *Close Encounters of the Third Kind*. The sculpture is mounted on a movable trailer and would be secured by pouring a small concrete plug in a post hole on a grassy city-owned parcel fronting the river across from the former Amazing Joe’s near the greenway.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote [00:14:40](#).

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:14:58 Rick Yencer (Newsman and Author):** Spoke critically regarding the Veridus police station contract and city debt. He noted historical precedent of the police department residing in City Hall, questioned the wisdom of seeking a new building given past facility shifts (referencing the justice center), pointed to empty commercial buildings and banks in Muncie, and expressed concern over the city’s reported \$72 million debt on Indiana Gateway compared to operating budgets. He also raised past concerns regarding Veridus’s work in other jurisdictions involving eminent domain. The Mayor briefly responded that hiring an outside firm is precisely intended to evaluate all unbiased options before decisions are made.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** None.
 - **Adjournment:** The meeting was officially adjourned by the presiding officer [00:17:53](#).
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